Naygam then ordered his men to break contact with the Chinese, withdraw to Sangam and regroup on the west bank of the Lohit.

By 7 a.m. on 22 October, Alpha Company along with the Assam Rifles platoon, plus the personnel from Hot Springs and Jachap who had been earlier ordered to fall back on Kibithu by Madiah, crossed the steel wire bridge and then destroyed it. For the time being, this effectively secured the right flank of the Kibithu garrison, for the Chinese could not cross the Lohit.

Others were not so lucky. The Chu post on the western flank, manned by a platoon of Assam Rifles, under the command of Naib Subedar Ao, was also attacked around the same time the previous evening. This post, out on an extreme limb, did not have the means to withstand the Chinese who overran the post, killing most of the men. Those who succeeded in getting away proceeded south, crossed a mountain range and after a month (during which time Subedar Ao died of exposure and fatigue) reached Hayuliang via Minuathang.

Madiah was now in a quandary. The Chu post having fallen the night before, his west flank was exposed. The Chinese were entrenched just northwest of him on PT 10000 from where they were directing accurate artillery fire at his positions in Kibithu itself. The successful withdrawal from the east flank and the destruction of the steel wire bridge had given him temporary respite, but it would only be a matter of time before the Chinese found a way to cross the river. After discussing the matter on the telephone with Brigadier Gill who had arrived at Walong, Madiah asked for further orders. Madiah then received a message telling him that the Walong/Kibithu sector was no longer his responsibility and that IV Corps would henceforth directly issue all further orders to all sub-units. By this time, HQ 4 Infantry Division had virtually ceased to exist and Niranjan Prasad was trekking back to Tawang from Zimithang.

A short while later, 6 Kumaon received orders from HQ IV Corps telling them to withdraw from Kibithu at last light and fall back on Walong.

THE DEPLOYMENT AT WALONG

Madiah now started to withdraw from Kibithu. Just then, Major Sharma’s Bravo Company was approaching Kibithu when it was stopped and told to turn back. It would now be the advance guard for the rest of the battalion that was strung out behind them. Despite the enveloping darkness, the